with Zion: Progressive Jewish-American Responses to the Israeli-Palestinian Conflict. Adopting their own self-chosen moniker, I took "progressive," *not* "liberal," as my term of choice.

No commonly agreed-upon taxonomy of terms—"liberal," "leftist," "radical"—exists to define "progressive" today with any precision, but the word generally is taken to designate a political position to the left of "liberal," the latter term having become a casualty of the culture wars and no longer enjoying the currency it once had. The slide from "liberal" to "progressive," however, involves more than just a semantic switch. As the political scientist Andrei Markovits explains in *Uncouth Nation*, "an uncompromising anti-Zionism, which occasionally borders on the antisemitic," has become requisite for membership in good standing in the progressive left. Together with anti-Americanism, anti-Zionism

> has become a kind of litmus test for progressive thinking and identity. . . . Just as any self-respecting progressive and leftist in Europe or America, regardless of which political shade, simply *had* to be on the side of the Spanish Republic in the 1930s, anti-Americanism and anti-Zionism have become *the* requisite proof of possessing a progressive conviction today.[2]

There are people within the progressive left who strongly oppose these tendencies—the British-based authors of the "Euston Manifesto" and writers featured in *Dissent* and "Democratiya" come immediately to mind. They make clear their concern with growing anti-Zionism and antisemitism, noting (I quote from the Euston Manifesto website, http://eustonmanifesto.org) their stand against "organizations of the left that are willing to entertain openly antisemitic speakers and to form alliances with antisemitic groups."

Among others on the left, though, an often strident anti-Zionism is part of the ideological package that gives them their political identity. Their inclination to liken Israel to Nazi Germany and white-ruled South Africa, and their frequent excoriations of the Jewish state as guilty of "racism," "apartheid," "ethnic cleansing," "war crimes," and "genocide" draw from a common lexicon of hyperbolically corrosive speech and have helped to fashion an intellectual and political climate that encourages the demonization of Israel and its supporters. These terms are constantly recycled through "criticism of Israel" and establish the strident tone of what I see as a still developing and distinctively polemical literary/political genre. Jacqueline Rose's reduction of Zionism to a form of collective lunacy and her attempt to link Herzl with Hitler; Joel Kovel's call for "true Jews" to "annihilate their particularism," "annihilate or transcend Zionism," and "annihilate the Jewish state"; Norman Finkelstein's claim that Israeli Jews are a "parasitic class"

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Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,